



A Quiet Hero's Winter Journey

picture by Echo

**Far away in a snowy hill, where few
looked closely, lived a shy snail.**



**The a shy snail was very small, and the
wide a snowy hill felt so very big.**





**Every day the a shy snail looked around
and wondered if it could ever matter.**



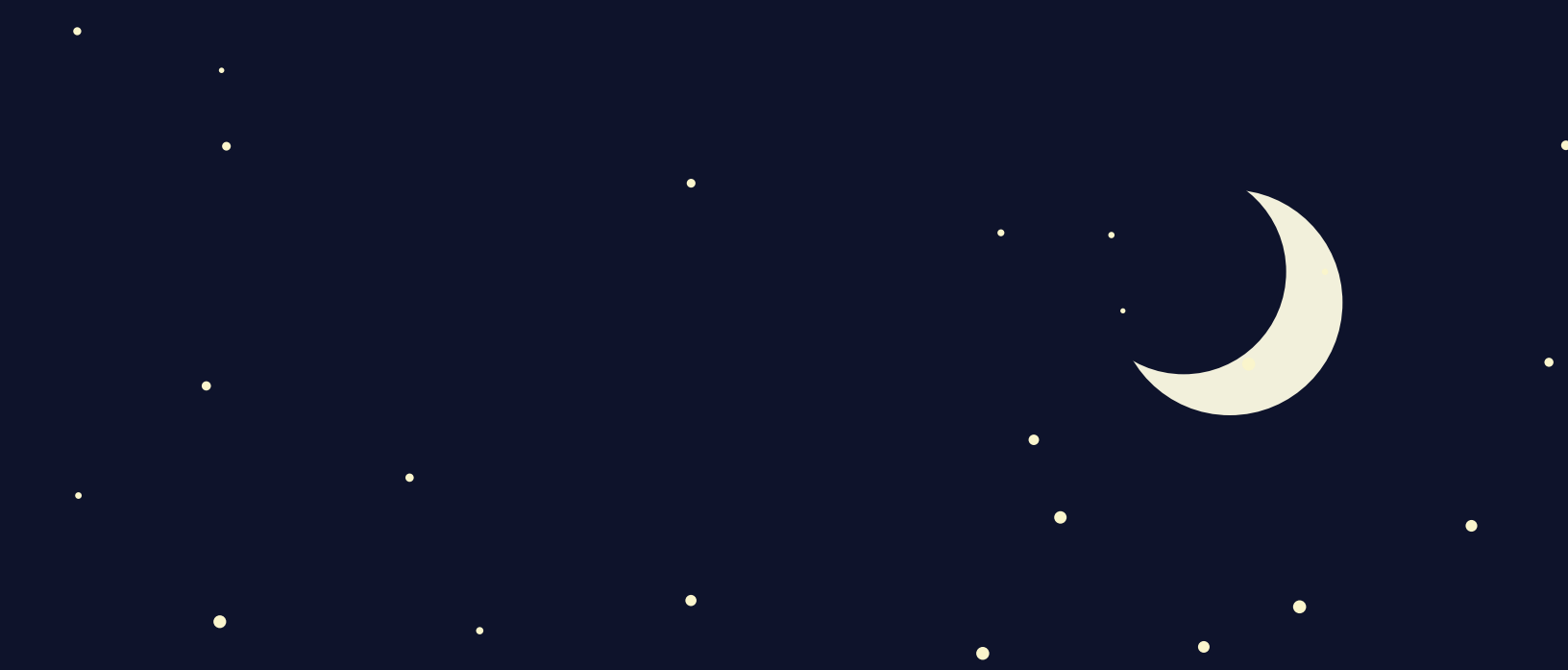
**Then one morning, something went wrong in
a snowy hill.**





**The light went out, and everyone was
afraid.**





**"I am too small," the a shy snail
thought. "But I will try anyway."**





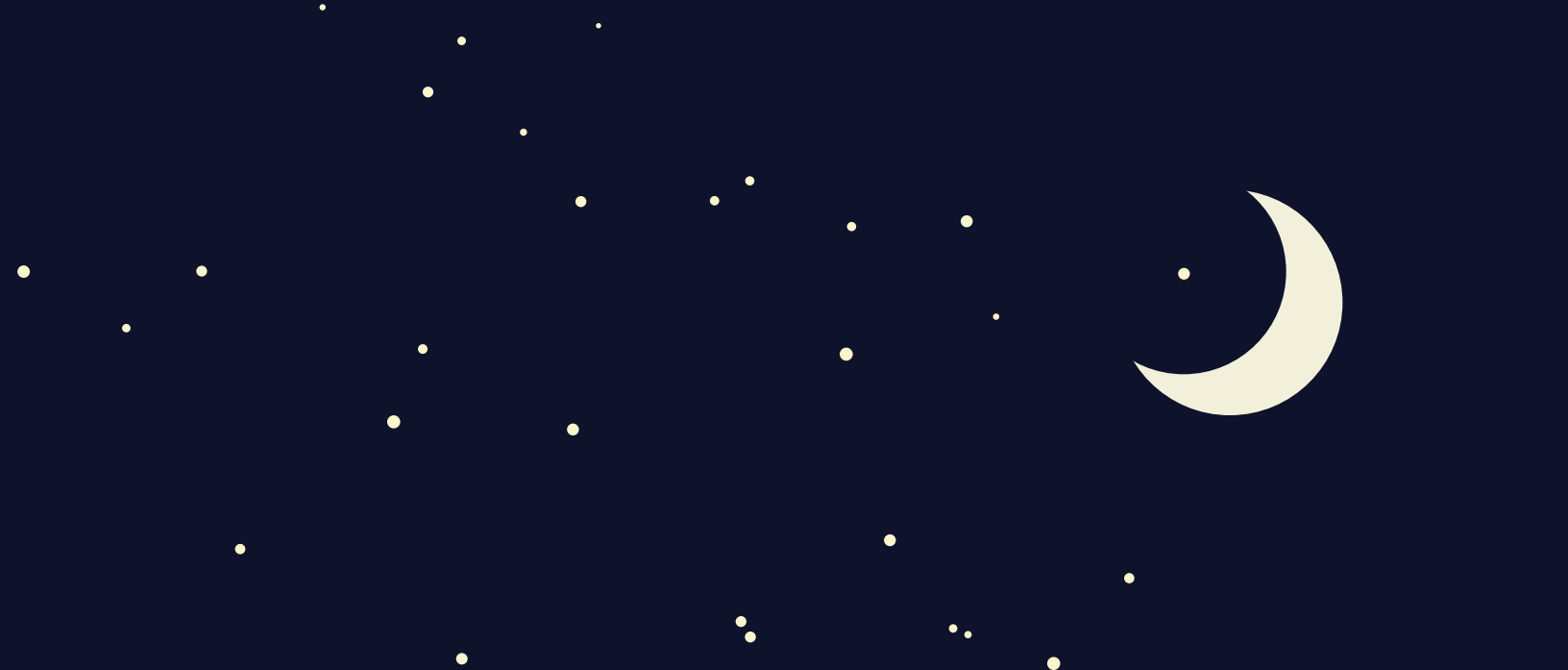
**The a shy snail took a deep breath and
tried with all its heart.**





**"You can do it," someone whispered. And
the a shy snail believed it.**



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and numerous small white stars scattered across the upper half. The lower half of the image is a solid dark blue background.

**It was not magic. It was trying, again
and again, until it worked.**



A dark blue night sky with a large, bright yellow crescent moon in the upper right. Numerous small, white stars of varying sizes are scattered across the sky.

**"You can do it," someone whispered. And
the a shy snail believed it.**





The first try did not work. It only made things wobble.





The a shy snail sat down and felt very
small indeed.





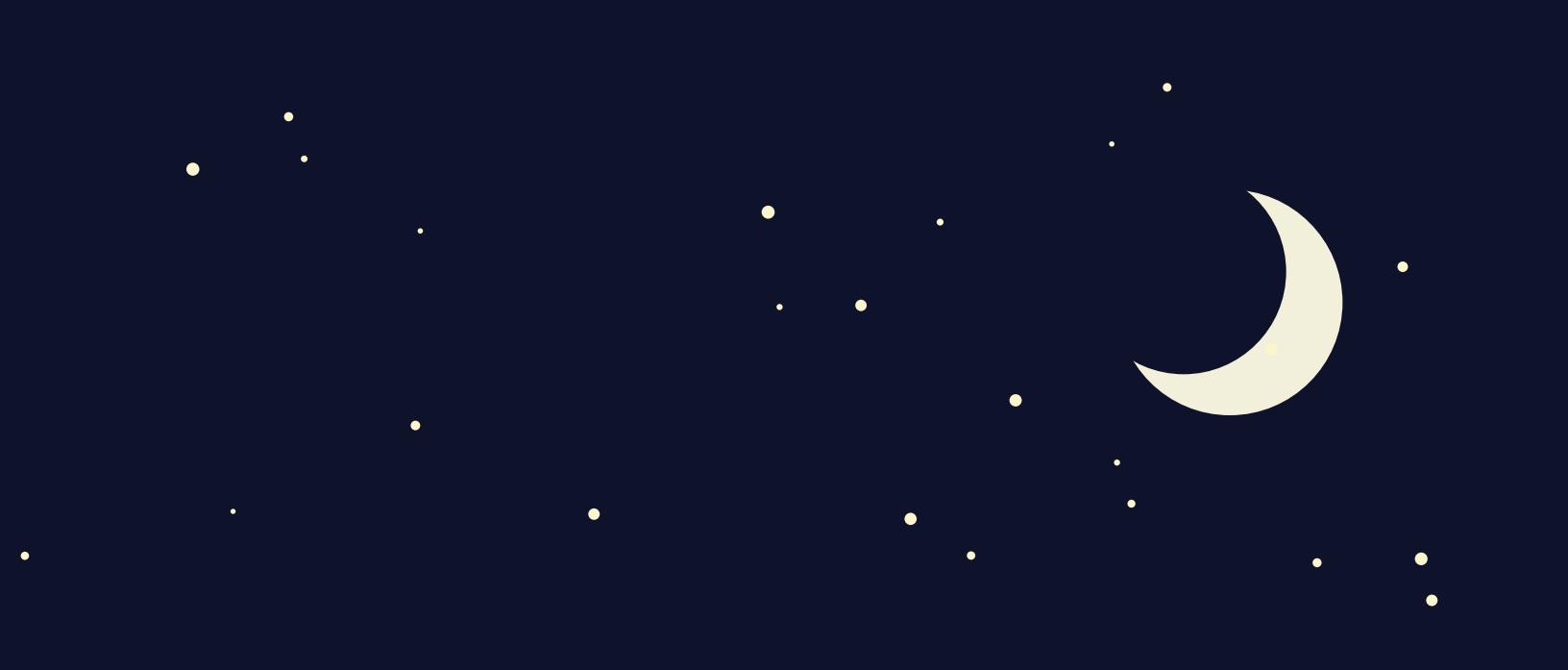
But it remembered the faces that needed help, and it stood up again.





**The second try was better. The third was
braver.**





**Little by little, the a shy snail kept
going, and the others began to help too.**





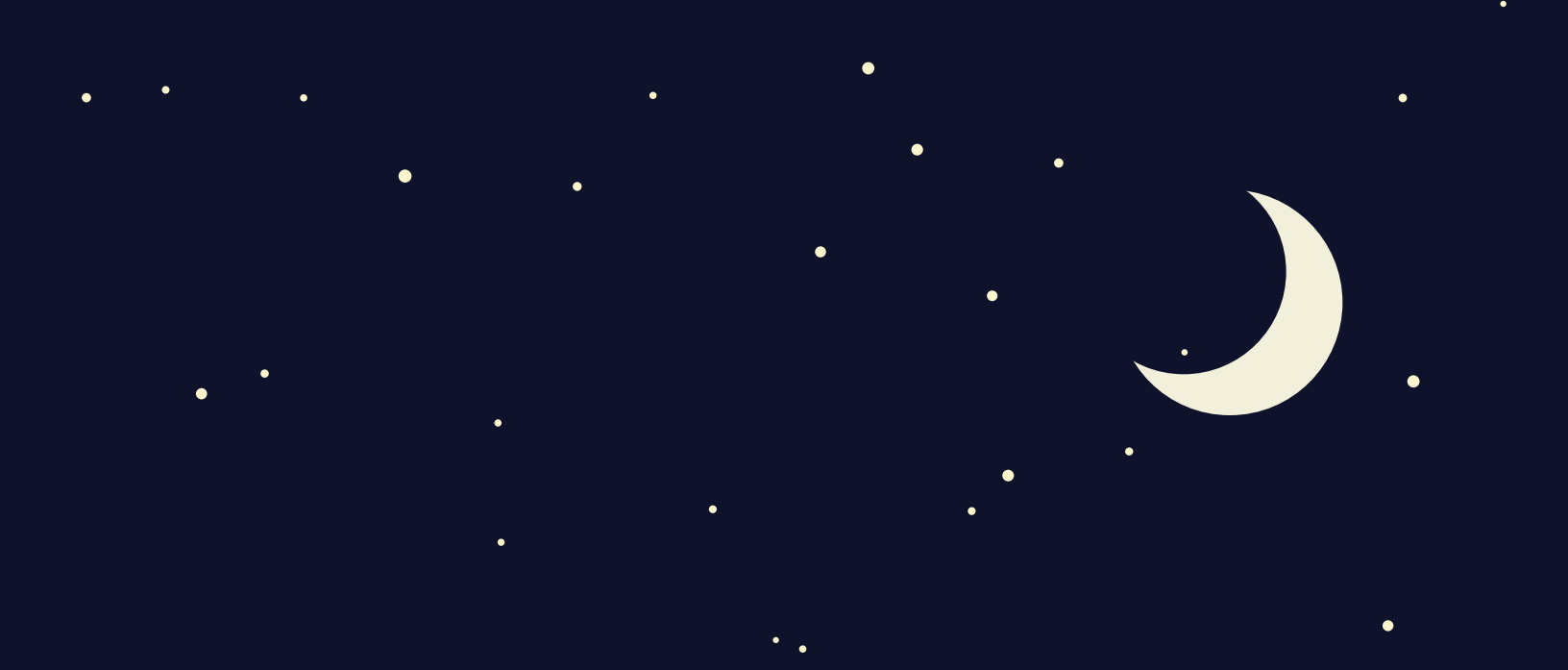
**It was not magic. It was trying, again
and again, until it worked.**





**The wind picked up, but the a shy snail
held on.**



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and several small white stars scattered across the frame.

**A friend called out, and the a shy snail
felt less alone.**





Every time it fell, it learned one new thing.





**"You can do it," someone whispered. And
the a shy snail believed it.**



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and several small white stars scattered across the frame.

**Step by step, the a shy snail found a new
way no one had seen before.**



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and several small white stars scattered across the upper half.

It tried again, and this time, it worked.



**Everyone in a snowy hill gathered around,
amazed.**





**The a shy snail learned: patience grows
the best things.**



The End

patience grows the best things

